

Bayern's reign under threat

Xabi Alonso's Bayer Leverkusen crushed 11-time defending champion Bayern Munich 3-0 at home to go five points clear at the top of the Bundesliga.

Leverkusen outclassed its title rivals with goals from Josip Stanisic, Alejandro Grimaldo and Jeremie Frimpong as it intensified its hunt for a first-ever German league title.

The win also boosted the credentials of Alonso, who has eased into his managerial career after a long, distinguished playing stint, which included a spell at Bayern.

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Haaland is back and firing

Manchester City's Erling Haaland celebrated his return to fitness with a second-half brace against Everton as Pep Guardiola's men intensified their hunt for a record-breaking fourth Premier League title.

Everton proved to be a tough nut to crack until the 70th minute when the 23-year-old Haaland — who missed nearly two months of action due to a leg injury — rifled in a right-footed shot following a corner. The Norwegian striker rounded up the win with a composed finish after he was set through on goal by Kevin de Bruyne, another injury returnee.

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No Olympic hat-trick for Brazil

Brazil's dreams of completing a hat-trick of Olympic gold medals in men's football suffered a premature collapse after it failed to make it past the South American Olympic qualifiers.

To make it worse for the Selecao, their fate was sealed by a defeat to arch-nemesis Argentina.

Coached by Javier Mascherano, Argentina scored the only goal of the game in the 78th minute through a Luciano Gondou header to book its ticket for the Paris Olympics.

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